

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/10: Vienna Circle programme and the analytic-synthetic division

START -> Vienna Circle: Schlick, Carnap, Neurath; Ayer is the English expositor.
INFLUENCES -> empiricism + mathematical logic + early Wittgenstein.
PHILOSOPHY -> logical clarification, not a rival source of empirical facts.
COGNITIVE MEANING -> truth-apt factual content or analytic logical function.
ANALYTIC -> true by meanings/rules; necessary; non-factual yet meaningful.
SYNTHETIC -> contingent; truth depends on experience; factual candidate.
SCIENTIFIC WORLDVIEW -> public evidence, coordination and unity ambitions.
DIVERSITY -> protocols, reduction, physicalism and confirmation remained disputed.
TRAP -> meaningful != scientifically true; non-cognitive != worthless.
ANSWER LINE -> one programme, evolving formulations and different internal routes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/10: Verification criterion, strong-weak fork and in-principle access

FACTUAL P -> cognitively meaningful only if experience could count for or against P.

ACTUAL VERIFICATION -> the evidence has been gathered now.

IN-PRACTICE TESTABILITY -> present technology and conditions make checking feasible.

IN-PRINCIPLE VERIFIABILITY -> relevant observations can be specified in principle.

STRONG -> experience could conclusively establish truth; sharp but over-exclusive.

WEAK -> possible evidence raises/lowers probability; Ayer's broader repair.

CONFIRMATION -> partial evidential support, not conclusive proof or truth itself.

PRESSURE -> laws, past, other minds, dispositions and theory terms.

TRAP -> falsifiability is Popper's rival demarcation rule, not this doctrine.

DILEMMA -> strong kills science; weak risks readmitting metaphysics.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/10: Positive case and scientific hard cases

POSITIVE CASE -> evidence, operational clarity, public testing, anti-obscurantism.

UNIVERSAL LAW -> finite observations never conclusively verify every instance.

DISPOSITION -> meaningful tendency may remain unmanifested in the present case.

PAST EVENT -> current traces, records and testimony provide indirect evidence.

OTHER MIND -> behaviour/expression provide public but non-conclusive evidence.

THEORETICAL ENTITY -> electron-talk belongs to a predictive theoretical network.

ROUTE -> theory + conditions + auxiliaries -> prediction -> observation report.

RESULT -> confirm, weaken or revise the connected system.

REPLY -> public predictive integration differs from insulation from evidence.

LIMIT -> science is saved as sentence-by-sentence demarcation becomes less sharp.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/10: Early Wittgenstein's influence and the positivist addition

TRACTATUS INFLUENCE -> facts can be said; logic is tautological; philosophy clarifies.

TAUTOLOGY -> shows logical form but does not picture a contingent fact.

SAYING/SHOWING -> cannot be identified wholesale with positivist verificationism.

CIRCLE'S ADDITION -> factual meaning requires possible experiential verification.

MODERN LOGIC -> analyse logical form beneath misleading surface grammar.

LOGICAL SYNTAX -> reveals misuse of categories, terms and quantificational forms.

PHILOSOPHY -> clarification of scientific language and limits of assertion.

HISTORICAL CAUTION -> influence does not make Wittgenstein a uniform Circle member.

AYER CAUTION -> English exposition is not identical with every Vienna doctrine.

ANSWER LINE -> inherited logical boundary plus an original empiricist meaning test.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/10: Metaphysical pseudo-proposition diagnostic

ASSERTION-LIKE SENTENCE -> first ask: analytic or tautological?

IF NO -> what possible experience would bear on truth or falsity?

IF NONE -> inspect each term's criterion of application.

CHECK -> grammatical disguise, category mistake and misuse of logical syntax.

PSEUDO-PROPOSITION -> assertion-like form without cognitive factual content.

CARNAP -> logical analysis diagnoses malformed or empty metaphysical constructions.

AYER -> unverifiable factual pretence fails the cognitive-meaning criterion.

NOT FALSE -> the positivist denies truth-conditions, not merely correspondence.

NOT WORTHLESS -> expressive, historical or existential significance may remain.

LIMIT -> the verdict is only as strong as the verification criterion itself.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/10: Religion, ethics and aesthetics: status versus significance

FIRST QUESTION -> does the utterance contain a factual, testable component?

ETHICAL JUDGEMENT -> Ayer treats basic evaluation as non-cognitive expression.

EMOTIVE SIGNIFICANCE -> evinces/influences attitudes; does not report a fact.

REPORTING FEELING != EXPRESSING APPROVAL.

PRESCRIPTIVE FUNCTION -> recommends conduct or commitment.

RELIGIOUS LANGUAGE -> may mix historical claims, symbols and devotional practice.

AESTHETIC LANGUAGE -> evaluation and response need not be measurement reports.

FAIRNESS -> analyse sentence-functions; never caricature a whole tradition.

OBJECTION -> reasons, consistency and embedded ethics pressure simple emotivism.

VERDICT -> non-factual cognitive status does not erase human significance.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/10: Linguistic theory of necessary propositions

EMPIRICIST PROBLEM -> how can logic and mathematics be necessary and a priori?

ANSWER -> analytic/tautological truth by definitions, conventions and rules.

TAUTOLOGY -> true under every admissible assignment; no contingent fact asserted.

LOGIC/MATHEMATICS -> organise inference and representation within a framework.

MEANINGFUL -> non-factual logical role; empirical verification is unnecessary.

CONVENTIONALISM -> framework rules explain necessity without supersensible objects.

EARLY WITTGENSTEIN -> tautology influence, not wholesale doctrinal identity.

KANT -> synthetic a priori challenges reduction to analyticity.

QUINE -> analytic-synthetic boundary appears circular and unstable.

REPLY/LIMIT -> strict consequences within chosen rules; choice standards need defence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/10: Protocol statements and the internal shift toward confirmation

PROTOCOL STATEMENT -> basic observation report used as an evidential checkpoint.
SCHLICK -> more foundational experiential role for observation reports.
NEURATH -> public, revisable protocols; no private incorrigible foundation.
THEORY -> predicts event; protocol records it; mismatch triggers distributed revision.
PHYSICALISM -> public coordination language, not crude denial of mental discourse.
UNITY OF SCIENCE -> intersubjective integration remained an ambition, not one formula.
DEVELOPMENT -> strict reduction -> probability -> confirmation.
FURTHER SHIFT -> reduction sentences, syntax/semantics and theoretical-term toleration.
THEORY-LADENNESS -> observation is not a neutral language-free bedrock.
VERDICT -> practice survives through revisability as foundational verification weakens.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/10: Carnapian tolerance, frameworks and conventionalist refinement

PRINCIPLE OF TOLERANCE -> state rules clearly; no single compulsory logical language.

LINGUISTIC FRAMEWORK -> syntax, semantics and standards for internal questions.

INTERNAL ANALYTIC QUESTION -> answered through framework rules.

INTERNAL FACTUAL QUESTION -> answered through evidence inside the framework.

ADOPTION QUESTION -> practical comparison: clarity, economy, fruitfulness, coordination.

CONVENTIONAL CHOICE != arbitrary consequence inside an adopted system.

ONTOLOGY -> some disputes can be recast as framework proposals rather than discoveries.

THEORETICAL TERMS -> retained when disciplined by inferential and test relations.

OBJECTION -> standards of framework choice themselves require justification.

LIMIT -> conceptual engineering does not dissolve every substantive ontological issue.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/10: Self-application, successor critiques, evaluation and answer spine

SELF-APPLICATION -> is the verification principle analytic or empirically verifiable?

IF NEITHER -> it fails its own test; if stipulative -> its universal authority weakens.

POPPER -> falsifiability demarcates science; it is not a positivist meaning criterion.

QUINE -> attacks analyticity and isolated testing; experience meets a web of belief.

KANT -> synthetic a priori challenges the linguistic reduction of necessity.

STRENGTHS -> clarity, evidence, anti-obscurantism, philosophy of science/language.

WEAKNESSES -> self-reference, laws, theory-ladenness, values, unstable analyticity.

DISTINGUISH -> meaning | truth | verification | confirmation | demarcation | significance.

ANSWER SPINE -> context -> definitions -> three doctrines -> objections/replies.

CONCLUSION -> enduring method of clarification, unsuccessful final tribunal of meaning.